How To Give Feedback

The Ultimate Guide For Exceptional Leaders

Chris Donnelly ©

4 MODELS FOR FEEDBACK AND IMPROVEMENT

SBI MODEL: Highly actionable and straightforward. Good for performance improvement.

S B I

Situation: Explain the situation.	**Behaviour :** Describe the behaviour.	**Impact:** Share the impact.
Example: During yesterday's team meeting.	**Example:** I noticed you interrupted a few times.	**Example:** It made your teammates feel unheard.

COIN MODEL: Emphasises relationship-building alongside feedback.

C O I N

Connect: Establish rapport.	**Observe:** Share observations.	**Impact:** Discuss the impact.	**Next Steps:** Agree on actions.
Example: Great work on the project last week.	**Example:** I noticed you took the lead without being asked.	**Example:** It kept the team organised and we hit the deadline.	**Example:** Keep taking initiative, it's making a difference.

GROW MODEL: Consultative approach that gives feedback with coaching.

G R O W

Goal: Define the objective.	**Reality:** Assess the situation.	**Options:** Explore various options.	**Way Forward:** Decide on next steps.
Example: Our goal is to increase team output by 10% this quarter.	**Example:** We're currently at 10% increase and need to improve. What can we do?	**Example:** We could have each person do a time audit or hold more training sessions.	**Example:** Let's start with a time audit and see where we're at in two weeks.

CEDAR MODEL: Comprehensive deep-dive useful for complex issues.

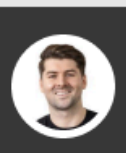
C	**Context:** Where and when the behaviour occurred.	**Example:** Whilst working on the marketing campaign.
E	**Examples:** Specific instances of what happened.	**Example:** I saw you missed two important deadlines.
D	**Diagnosis:** Your interpretation of the situation.	**Example:** I want you to prioritise your tasks better.
A	**Action:** What needs to change.	**Example:** We'll assess your progress in two weeks.
R	**Review:** How you will follow up.	**Example:** It resulted in our launch being delayed

HARVARD'S TOP 5 TIPS TO GIVE EFFECTIVE FEEDBACK

1. **Lead with Empathy** — Put yourself in your team members' shoes and consider their perspectives before providing feedback.
2. **Prepare, Prepare, Prepare** — Strategise your approach before delivering feedback, considering the individual's personality, past performance, and responsiveness.
3. **Be Specific and Impactful** — Focus on specific behaviours when providing feedback, identifying the root cause, stating the impact, and connecting it to consequences.
4. **Encourage Open Dialogue** — Incorporate enquiry into feedback sessions, asking employees about their perspective and ensuring they understand the feedback.
5. **Embrace a Forward-Looking Mindset** — Once feedback is delivered, shift focus to the future, emphasising how the recipient can change their behaviour.

HOW TO GIVE FEEDBACK IN MEETINGS

1. **Make it their meeting, not yours**
   - Listen intently and offer genuine support
   - It's about them, not you
2. **Build rapport before diving in**
   - Take a sincere interest in their life first
   - Strengthen your connection before the agenda
3. **Uncover their needs**
   - Repeatedly ask: "What do you need from me?"
   - Find out how you can best support them
4. **Sandwich constructive criticism**
   - Share positive feedback on both sides
   - "I really appreciate how you... Here's one area to improve... Overall, great work on..."
5. **Choose a distraction-free environment**
   - Find a quiet, private space to meet
   - Consider offsite meetings for fewer interruptions
6. **Listen with your full presence**
   - Put away your devices and really focus
   - Make them feel heard and understood
7. **Provide specific, actionable feedback**
   - Always include concrete examples
   - Empower them with clear next steps
8. **Co-create meaningful goals**
   - Involve them in the goal-setting process
   - Encourage them to share their own aspirations and ambitions.



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